

the child could have been playing with other kids her age, learning in the process, how to resolve conflicts and take on leadership roles.

A study published in the October 2014 issue of 'Computers in Human Behavior' revealed that digital media decreases children's ability to read other people's emotions and social cues. Participants, 11-12 years of age, were asked to recognise human emotions from a series of photographs and muted videos. Half of them were then sent to a camp to complete traditional camping activities such as hiking, archery and learning about nature. Access to their gadgets was taken away, while the other half went about as usual with their day on digital media (which on a typical school day averaged four-and-a-half hours of screen time). The post-test revealed that the campers showed marked and significant improvement in their ability to guess emotions, while the gadget-toting group showed only slight improvement, revealing just how important face-to-face interactions are.

Effect on physical well-being

Tech's negative effect on physical health is irrefutable. Not only is the apple of your eye ruining his vision by not blinking, constantly focusing on the gadget (thereby making it hard to eventually adjust to viewing distances) and sitting in pitch dark with the bright screen, he's also increasing his chances of being overweight and unhealthy by not getting enough exercise and sunlight. Sleep problems due to exposure to light emitted by gadgets right before sleeping and orthopaedic complications are other issues that could also negatively affect your child's daily life and simply can't be ignored.

We should just hide it all away from them, right?

Isn't it wise then to give your child a Play-Doh set rather than an iPad? It only makes sense right, considering the former will help unleash your toddler's creativity compared to tech consumption on the iPad? Not really. Why? Read on.

Benefits of tech

Think back to many years ago. Inventions that were new back then – be it the telephone, radio or even the internet – were plagued with concerns about their evil effects on users, but aren't even given a second thought now. Change is scary. Present day tech may not be childhood as you know